hūmānus

update since 29 June · Q3 2026 Board Meeting

29 October 2026

Humanising Justice

ACCOUNTABILITY · COMMUNITY · EVIDENCE

Sponsor: Eva Buzo, Executive Director · Agenda item TBC · 15 minutes · Discussion · DRAFT for ED sign-off

Three goals guide everything we do

Our 2024–29 strategy frames the year.

1

Victims secure outcomes in line with their own conception of justice.

2

Victims are empowered by the process of pursuing justice — not just by its results.

3

Justice processes are transformed to put victims at the centre.

The September retreat broadened our framing from serious international crimes to human rights violations (slide 11).

Where the work has sat since June

29 June – 12 October 2026, by funded programme and other significant strands.

Programme / strand	Funder	Status since 29 June
Rohingya in India — legal protection	Core funding	Delhi detention roundtable convened lawyers (5 Jul); Right to Education route for detained minors developed; habeas and bail filings in preparation.
Bangladesh dialogue	FCDO (UK)	Phase I delivery continuing; inputs to Stimson-led interim report (Jun–Oct); Jun–Oct financial claim in preparation.
Towards a More Peaceful Arakan	Swiss FDFA via Stimson Center	Rohingya dialogue continuing; FDFA head grant and joint workplan requested from Stimson.
Accountability for business and human rights	Core funding	Meta response to our case; Amnesty × hūmānus UNGA side event (25 Sep); Adani coordination and investigation continuing.
Public engagement	Core funding	Against the Tide swim (Small Islands Coalition, Seychelles, UNGA); Berkeley keynote (28 Sep); OSF partner retreat, Mexico.
Research — Rohingya analysis	[Eva to confirm]	Sawyadullah's 10 analysis reports; website launching November 2026.

Women's Dialogue (SDC) grant ended 30 April 2026, as reported at Q2. Finance: see Stacy McGill's Q3 Board Finance Report and Forecast Report.

Rohingya in India — legal protection

Core funded · no project grant · Lead: Arati Ranade, India Programme Manager

What the strand is

Direct legal intervention for detained Rohingya refugees in India, building a cross-state network of lawyers and an evidentiary base on detention and deportation patterns. Funded from core — no donor restriction on case selection or strategy.

Since 29 June

- Delhi detention roundtable (5 July) — lawyers from across states convened over three panels to discuss detention litigation strategy.
- Right to Education — strategy note drafted on an education-rights route for detained minors, alongside the refugee route; raised with African states in Geneva (25 August).
- Litigation pipeline — habeas corpus petition in drafting; bail application being finalised for counsel's review; Right to Information petitioner being identified.
- Lawyer network — Jammu & Kashmir leads in place; Rajasthan, Tripura and Hyderabad being assessed. Case-law report on Rohingya deportation in preparation.

Why this matters for the board

The retreat agreed to continue the lawyer-network and coordination approach and to take stock of the Rohingya work after six months, around March 2027 (slide 11). The ED will report the outcome to the board.

Bangladesh dialogue programme

FCDO (UK) · continuing programme

What the funding supports

Sustained dialogue and engagement work with Rohingya leadership in Bangladesh, complementing the Swiss/Stimson Arakan partnership. Operates in a deficit / reimbursement model — hūmānus spends and is reimbursed in arrears.

Since 29 June

- Phase I delivery continuing.
- hūmānus inputs being prepared for the Stimson-led FCDO interim report covering June–October.
- June–October financial claim being prepared in GBP; Schedule 2 disbursement amounts being agreed and countersigned.
- Cash timing — Stacy McGill's Q3 report shows the FCDO Phase II claim as the next contracted receipt, indicatively November.

Towards a More Peaceful Arakan

Swiss FDFA, via Stimson Center as prime · hūmānus as implementing partner

What the project is

An 18-month partnership (December 2025 – May 2027) to identify, create, and support trust-building opportunities among Rohingya, Arakanese, and Bangladesh stakeholders, combining bilateral engagement, capacity building, and facilitated dialogue.

Since 29 June

- Rohingya dialogue work continuing with Rohingya leadership.
- Request made to Stimson for the FDFA head grant and the approved joint workplan.
- Partner engagement — PHRD Myanmar partner discussion (16 July); Swiss Peace Partners Network, Geneva (6 August).

Accountability for business and human rights

Core funded · legal action, regulatory complaint and advocacy — confirmed as a core model at the retreat

THE FRAMEWORK

Bringing together our work that holds business actors accountable for contribution to, or benefit from, serious international crimes — across litigation, regulatory complaint, and investor-facing advocacy.

ACTIVE WORKSTREAMS

Meta / Facebook

Meta has responded to our case, including a request for particulars. [Eva to confirm: source to be supplied] Amnesty × hūmānus side event at UNGA (25 Sep); documentary narrative and video series in production.

Adani

Coordination and investigation work continuing, including research on Australian super-fund exposure, fiduciary-duty case law, the OFAC civil probe and Adani Defence.

Other accountability work

US and UK greenwashing opinions (Reuben brothers / Escénica) in progress. CERD / ICJ brief concerning Australia in preparation.

Note for the Board

At Q2 we proposed a dedicated Adani paper for this meeting. Coordination and investigation work is continuing; the board is updated through this report.

Public engagement

Core funded · Against the Tide, speaking and donor relations

Against the Tide

- Eva Buzo Swim × Small Islands Coalition (28 August); Islands Swim: Seychelles (15 September); small-islands press, social and documentary session at UNGA (25 September).

Speaking

- Berkeley (28 September) — keynote, Human Rights for Victims of Conflict in a Fragmenting World; session with Berkeley IIS clinic students on conflict monitoring.

Donor relations

- OSF partner retreat, Mexico — Finding Each Other on Shifting Ground, bringing together around 100 OSF partners; good connections made. Preceded by online pre-gathering sessions in July.

Further activities

Advisory work outside our funded programmes

Since 29 June

- Australian war crimes, victim participation — advice to two sets of clients in Australia on victim participation in prosecutions of alleged war crimes committed in Afghanistan.
- Caste-based discrimination — advice on a complaint to the Australian Human Rights Commission against a New South Wales local council, concerning discrimination against Dalit, Bahujan and Adivasi communities. Referred via Salil Shetty; instructed September 2026.

Why this matters for the board

Both matters fall within the broadened human rights violations framing agreed at the retreat (slide 11). They are confidential client matters, so details are held by the ED and are not set out in this paper.

Research — Rohingya analysis

Sawyadullah · supporting dialogue activities and Rohingya leadership

What the strand is

Ten analysis reports by Sawyadullah on Rohingya relationships with the United States, China, Bangladesh, India and Pakistan — to aid our dialogue activities and support Rohingya leadership.

Since 29 June

- Website to host the work in development, launching November 2026.
- A workshop on the content will be run in the Rohingya language.

Strategy retreat — what we decided

Team retreat, September 2026 · strategy, impact and organisational focus

Strategy and impact

- Plan from what clients need — an outcomes ladder linking litigation, mediation and community engagement to meaningful results.
- Broaden the framing from serious international crimes to human rights violations; stay people-focused and prioritise systemic change.
- Corporate accountability — legal action, regulatory complaints and advocacy — adopted as a core model, including Adani and Facebook.
- Rohingya — continue the lawyer-network and coordination approach, and take stock of progress after six months.

Priorities

- Keep excellence, rigour and clear accountability central; new geographies only where needs-driven.
- Tell the organisation's story well and show impact to clients and funders; consider dedicated fundraising capacity.

Strategic outlook and watch-items

Things to keep in view between now and the February 2027 meeting.

Cash position

Cash USD 33,679 at 30 September; no contracted receipts until the FCDO Phase II claim (indicatively November) and OSF Year 3 (January 2027). Per Stacy McGill's Q3 Board Finance Report.

Strategic framing

The retreat broadened the framing of the board-approved 2024–29 strategy from serious international crimes to human rights violations — brought to the board for discussion.

Rohingya work

Progress to be taken stock of around March 2027, between board meetings; the ED will report the outcome to the board.

Fundraising and post-OSF horizon

Dedicated fundraising capacity under consideration — continues the Q2 item 6 discussion on matching ambition to fundraising.

Governance and entity

Legal name change VAI → hūmānus notified to OSF grant contacts; staff contract renewals in progress. Finance detail in Stacy McGill's papers.

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